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题目：The Impact of TikTok Cross-Border Marketing Content on Malaysian Consumers' Purchase Intentions for Chinese Products

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TikTok 跨境营销内容对消费者购买意愿的影响调查

摘　要：本研究旨在探讨 TikTok 跨境营销内容如何影响马来西亚消费者对中国商品的购买意愿。基于刺激—机体—反应（S-O-R）理论框架，本文分析内容特征（包括内容可信度、内容真实性、信息质量、诊断性及娱乐性）如何影响消费者的信任与感知价值，并进一步影响其购买意愿。本研究采用定量研究方法，通过问卷调查收集了 201 份来自马来西亚 TikTok 用户的数据，并运用偏最小二乘结构方程模型（PLS-SEM）进行分析。研究结果显示，内容可信度、内容真实性及信息质量对消费者信任具有显著正向影响；信息质量与诊断性对感知价值具有显著正向影响；同时，信任与感知价值均显著促进购买意愿。然而，娱乐性对感知价值呈现正向影响，与原假设不一致；此外，跨境购物经验对信任与购买意愿关系的调节作用未得到支持。本研究为理解 TikTok 营销在跨境电商情境下如何影响消费者行为提供了有价值的理论与实践启示。

关键词： TikTok 营销；跨境电商；信任；感知价值；购买意愿；马来西亚

The Impact of TikTok Cross-Border Marketing Content on Malaysian Consumers' Purchase Intentions for Chinese Products

Abstract: This study focuses on the impact of cross-border marketing content published on the TikTok platform on Malaysian consumers ' willingness to purchase Chinese goods. The theoretical basis adopts the ' stimulus-organism-response ' (S-O-R) model and the analysis is carried out accordingly. The content features are placed at the center of the investigation, especially in terms of credibility, authenticity, information quality, diagnosticity and entertainment value. Its role in trust, perceived value and final purchase intention has become the focus of attention. The data were derived from a sample of 201 Malaysian TikTok users and the analysis method was partial least squares structural equation model (PLS-SEM). The analysis results show that credibility, authenticity and information quality have a significant effect on the improvement of trust. Information quality and diagnostic value have a positive effect on perceived value. Both trust and perceived value significantly promote the increase of purchase intention. Although entertainment value has been expected to have a negative effect, empirical evidence shows that it has a positive impact. The cross-border shopping experience has not shown a moderating effect, which can be verified by data examples. It can be seen that the content strategy on the TikTok platform has potential value in cross-border marketing, and also provides a new perspective for understanding consumer behavior in the digital environment.

Keywords: TikTok marketing, cross-border e-commerce, trust, perceived value, purchase intention, Malaysia

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Chapter 1 Introduction

1.1 Research Background

In recent years, social media has become an indispensable tool in advertising and e-commerce. In particular, applications such as TikTok have rapidly increased in popularity worldwide, bringing together a large number of users with young people as the main body. Initially, the application was only a place to share entertainment short videos; later, it gradually turned into the main place for online commodity trading. Nowadays, enterprises and video creators use this platform to display products, interact with audiences, and have an impact on users ' purchase preferences.

A key feature of TikTok is that its algorithm recommendation system is widely used. Through the ' Recommend for You ' page, the platform pushes video content based on the interests and behaviors of users during use. Therefore, marketing information can reach potential consumers, even if they have not actively searched for related products. Zulli and Zulli (2020) have pointed out that TikTok 's algorithm plays an important role in users ' access to platform content. Product-related videos are more likely to appear in the user 's information flow, and the exposure of advertising content is increased.

The development of digital platforms, coupled with the progress of global logistics networks, has greatly promoted the popularity of cross-border e-commerce. Consumers can now place orders directly to overseas sellers through apps or websites, and geographical barriers in the traditional sense are effectively broken. In recent years, many Chinese sellers have used TikTok to market their products to overseas users, with a particular focus on markets such as Malaysia. These promotion activities usually rely on short video, grass planting recommendation of web celebrity bloggers and live delivery to attract and transform potential customers. The integration of modern logistics systems and social media makes it easier for sellers to connect with consumers around the world.

Purchasing goods from overseas retailers may face greater uncertainty than purchasing from domestic online retailers. Consumers who have doubts about product quality, delivery cycle or return terms, in this context, rely mainly on information extracted from network content to complete product evaluation.

The authenticity, credibility and quality of the information in the content have a significant effect on consumers ' interpretation of marketing messages and purchase decisions (Lou and Yuan, 2019 ; Filieri, 2015), which has been confirmed by previous studies.

Product advertisements on short video platforms often incorporate entertainment components. Videos posted on TikTok are often accompanied by background music, narration, humorous bridge segments and creative editing techniques, which enhance the attraction of marketing content and attract public attention (Meng et al., 2024).

The characteristics of short video content may have an impact on consumers ' product cognition and attitude. Therefore, it is of great significance for researchers and marketing practitioners to understand how different types of content affect consumer cognition.

The popularity of TikTok among Malaysian youth groups continues to rise and there are many people who watch various product display videos frequently. Although user engagement is high, there is still a lack of understanding of how TikTok 's international marketing specifically shapes Malaysian consumers ' perception of Chinese products.

1.2 Research Objectives

The purpose of this study is to explore the impact of international marketing content in TikTok platform on Malaysian consumers ' willingness to purchase Chinese products. The specific features presented by the video are included in the scope of analysis, such as content credibility, content authenticity, information quality, diagnosticity and entertainment.

The cognitive process of consumers is also concerned in this study and the degree of trust and perceived value are particularly prominent. In the context of online shopping, buyers cannot directly contact or inspect goods before payment, which makes the above factors particularly critical. It can be seen that if video content can effectively enhance trust or strengthen perceived value, it may indirectly affect consumption decision-making.

The formation mechanism of actual purchase intention is also discussed in depth, and trust and perceived value play an intermediary role in this process. Examples show that individual 's previous cross-border shopping experience may regulate this path of action. In the face of similar marketing videos, there may be differences in the response patterns of experienced and inexperienced people.

1.3 Research Question

Based on the research objectives, this study proposes the following research questions:

1. How do TikTok cross-border content characteristics — content credibility, content authenticity, information quality, diagnosticity and entertainment value — influence Malaysian consumers' trust in Chinese cross-border products?
2. To what extent do these TikTok content characteristics shape Malaysian. consumers' perceived value of Chinese cross-border products, including perceived quality, usefulness and overall value?
3. How does consumer trust in Chinese cross-border products influence. Malaysian consumers' purchase intention on TikTok?
4. How does perceived value influence Malaysian consumers' purchase. intention toward Chinese cross-border products showcased on TikTok?
5. Does cross-border shopping experience moderate the relationship between. trust and purchase intention?

1.4 Research Significance

1.4.1 Theoretical Significance

From a theoretical perspective, this study contributes some new insights to the existing literature in the field of social media shopping and digital advertising. Specifically, the user response caused by foreign advertisements on the TikTok platform is explained by the stimulus-organism-response (S-O-R) framework.

As a stimulating factor, how different video elements act on individuals is more clearly presented through the analysis of this study, and the influence mechanism of social media content on people 's views and final purchase decisions is thus revealed. TikTok 's role as a shopping platform is also of particular concern to this study, which is based on previous research on short video advertising.

Most of the previous studies have focused on social media advertising or online celebrity marketing and the specific functions of TikTok video how to enhance user trust and perceived value, the current understanding is still insufficient. Once the above aspects are focused, the gap in the existing knowledge system about the impact of digital content on users has been filled.

1.4.2 Practical Significance

From a practical point of view, the results of this study provide a reference value for companies and advertisers who use TikTok to reach a global audience. After the specific features of the video that affect the user 's perception of the product are identified, advertisers can formulate more effective marketing strategies accordingly.

Malaysian users ' needs when watching product videos on the TikTok platform can also be better understood by Chinese marketers operating overseas through these results. If the content is of credibility, authenticity and information quality, marketers are expected to build trust and attract a wider range of people to make purchases. The effective attraction of the target audience and the strengthening of the overall marketing activities can be achieved by focusing on the above areas.

Chapter 2 Theoretical Framework

2.1 Social Media Influencer Marketing

In recent years, one of the social media platforms has been regarded as the most critical channel in digital marketing. More and more companies choose to cooperate with online celebrities and content creators on social media to promote their products and services online. Compared with traditional advertising, Internet celebrities can build a unique and direct connection with fans, which make recommendation more important and easier to be accepted by the audience.

In the shaping of consumer views and purchase intentions, the role played by online celebrities has been confirmed by previous studies. The empirical of Lim et al. (2017) show that when Internet celebrities are identified as reliable and have professional knowledge, their impact on consumers' purchase intention is particularly significant. Saima and Khan (2020) emphasize that users' reactions to social media promotion messages are driven by the authenticity of online celebrities.

Djafarova and Rushworth (2017) further illustrated that the authenticity of online celebrities has a significant effect on consumers' purchase decisions, especially on platforms such as Instagram. Lou and Yuan (2019) also observed that the combination of content value and online celebrity authenticity can enhance consumers' trust and enhance their purchase intention. It can be seen that Internet celebrity marketing is not only limited to product promotion itself, but also the establishment of trust relationship and the context of Malaysia, this type of marketing is particularly prevalent among young groups, which are mainly active on platforms such as Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube.

The research example of Ayob et al. (2024) shows that peer influence and social media activities are significantly related to the purchase intention of Malaysian consumers. Impact marketing is thus regarded as an effective strategy for enterprises to reach the digital generation and guide their consumption behavior.

2.2 Short-Form Video Marketing

The digital advertising pattern has been rapidly changed by short video platforms. On platforms such as TikTok, users can create and share short video content that

combines entertainment, creativity and product promotion. Compared with traditional advertising forms, more interactive and attractive short videos have been proved to be very effective in attracting users ' attention. Users ' cognition and purchase intention are significantly affected by the characteristics of short video content, which has been supported by many research examples.

Meng et al. (2024) pointed out that consumers ' brand awareness and purchase behavior are significantly affected by the content characteristics of short video advertising on TikTok, such as credibility, professionalism, attractiveness and authenticity.

Video content with both entertainment and information value can enhance user participation and increase the possibility of online purchase. This conclusion is revealed by the research example of Liu and Wang (2023).

By presenting product details through demonstrations, evaluations and real-world usage scenarios, short videos enable users to gain a more comprehensive understanding of the product. User uncertainty is reduced and wise decision-making is supported. It can be seen that short video advertising has become an indispensable key tool in modern social e-commerce.

2.3 TikTok and Social Commerce

TikTok has evolved from a single entertainment platform to a cutting-edge social e-commerce ecosystem. The content recommendation mechanism, live broadcast form and embedded shopping function driven by the algorithm enable merchants to directly display and sell products to consumers on the platform. It can be seen that the proportion of social e-commerce in the digital marketing field is continuing to increase.

Its recommendation system takes the algorithm as the core driving force, which constitutes one of the significant advantages of TikTok. Unlike most traditional social media platforms that are highly dependent on the fan network, the ' Recommend for you ' page filters content based on user interest and behavior data. Zulli and Zulli (2020) have pointed out that through this mechanism, content creators can reach a wider audience even if they lack a large fan base, thus improving the visibility and effectiveness of content marketing.

Interactive functions such as ' likes ', ' comments ' and live broadcasts enhance users ' perception of social presence in the platform and stimulate a higher degree of enthusiasm for participation. Omar and Dequan (2020) observed that such interactive

elements not only increase the level of user activity, but also strengthen the internal connection strength of the online community. Wongkitrungrueng and Assarut (2020) further emphasized that live broadcasting combined with real-time interaction can significantly enhance customers ' trust and willingness to participate, which are regarded as the key drivers of social e-commerce purchase decisions.

Previous studies have also shown that social e-commerce platforms play an important role in guiding consumer behavior. Hajli et al. (2017) proposed that in the context of digital interaction, social interaction, user-generated content and trust work together in the formation process of purchase intention. Sun et al. (2019) also found that the live broadcast function helps to improve the level of consumer interest and has a positive effect on purchase intention. Examples show that TikTok has become an effective channel to promote product promotion and influence consumption decisions in the context of social e-commerce.

2.4 Content Characteristics in Social Media Marketing

In the social media environment, product characteristics play a key role in shaping consumer cognition. Before purchasing, consumers can neither contact nor observe the goods themselves, and often need to use digital images and text descriptions to judge.

It can be seen that authenticity, credibility, information quality, diagnosticity and entertainment will have a significant impact on consumers ' response to marketing content. Consumers ' judgment of content credibility is often based on their subjective perception of authenticity and credibility. Lou and Yuan (2019) have pointed out that credible marketing information can enhance consumers ' trust in spokespersons and the brands they represent. Saima and Khan (2020) also found that in the context of online celebrity marketing, consumers ' perceived trust constitutes an important driving force for their purchase decisions.

The authenticity of products is regarded as another core dimension in social media marketing. If the content appears to be true, it is usually considered to be more frank and sincere, which helps to build users ' trust in online celebrities and their promotion products. Studies have shown that consumers are more likely to respond positively to marketing information that presents a natural state than highly commercialized content (Lou and Yuan, 2019).

Information quality reflects the authenticity and relevance of the content provided to consumers. Having high-quality information can help users understand product attributes more accurately and form a more rational purchase judgment accordingly.

Filieri (2015) proposed that when products get comments on the network platform, real and credible information has a significant effect on the formation of consumer views. Once consumers obtain clear and practical product information, they tend to give the product a higher rating.

The so-called " diagnostic information " refers to the degree of relevance of such information in the process of consumers ' evaluation of product quality. Jiang and Benbasat (2007) believe that such information can provide consumers with key clues to more effectively judge the quality of goods. In the online shopping scene, this effect is particularly prominent, because consumers can neither touch nor directly observe the object. Descriptive information helps to deepen users ' understanding of product characteristics and enhance their perceived value.

Entertainment value is ultimately reflected in the attractiveness and interest of the content to the audience. In the short video platform, it has become a common strategy to integrate entertainment forms such as comedy elements, music clips and narrative techniques into product promotion. Meng et al. (2024) showed that highly entertaining content is more likely to attract the attention of the audience and enhance their interest in commercial information. However, if the marketing content focuses too much on the entertainment level, key information for evaluating product quality may be missing. At this time, consumers may be difficult to accurately grasp the true value of the product, which in turn leads to a decline in their recognition of the perceived value of the promotion content.

2.5 Trust in Online and Social Commerce

Trust is widely regarded as one of the key factors affecting online consumer behavior. In the digital environment, product quality, seller integrity and transaction security often make consumers doubtful.

It can be seen that trust plays a fundamental role in reducing perceived risk and promoting the development of online business. Previous studies have pointed out that consumers ' willingness to purchase products from the online market and social media is significantly affected by trust. Lu et al. (2016) have confirmed that customers ' willingness to purchase products through social e-commerce platforms is significantly

driven by their trust in online sellers. The research of Wang et al. (2022) also shows that trust is a key factor in the formation of purchase intention in a variety of digital commerce situations.

2.6 Perceived Value

The evaluation of the relationship between the full benefits of the product and the price paid by the consumer is called perceived value. Zeithaml (1988) pointed out that the perceived value is the perception of the exchange between the customer's income and the payment when the customer purchases the product.

In the context of online shopping, the factors that affect perceived value are diverse, including the relationship between product information, price and value, and the judgment of product quality. It can be seen that the formation of perceived value is not covered by a single dimension. Examples show that consumers often adjust their expectations of value based on available product descriptions. When consumers consider a product to be inexpensive, they develop a positive attitude towards it and are more likely to consider buying it.

2.7 Purchase Intention

Purchase intention is widely used as an indicator in consumer behaviour research, as it indicates the likelihood of a consumer purchasing a specific product. It reflects the consumer's desire or intention to make a purchase in the future.

Previous research indicates that purchase intention is influenced by various psychological factors, including trust, perceived value and attitudes towards marketing materials. Wang et al. (2022) found that consumers' purchase intentions in a digital commerce environment are strongly influenced by their perceptions of trust and the enjoyment they experience when interacting with online platforms.

2.8 Cross-Border Online Shopping

Cross-border e-commerce refers to online transactions in which consumers purchase goods from sellers in other countries. In recent years, the popularity of cross-border shopping has grown alongside the rapid development of global digital platforms and international logistics systems.

However, cross-border transactions often involve a higher level of uncertainty compared to domestic online shopping. Consumers may harbour concerns regarding delivery times, product quality and return policies.

Previous research has shown that uncertainty is a decisive factor influencing consumers' purchase intentions in the context of cross-border e-commerce (Liu & Liu, 2018; Zhu et al., 2019).

Furthermore, consumers who have already experienced cross-border shopping may feel more reassured when purchasing from overseas retailers. Such experiences can reduce perceived uncertainty and influence the impact of trust on consumers' purchase intentions within the cross-border online shopping environment.

2.9 Theoretical Foundation: Stimulus-Organism-Response (S-O-R) Model

The 'stimulus-organism-response (S-O-R) model', originally proposed by Albert Mehrabian and James A. Russell (1974), has been widely applied in research into consumer behaviour. This model explains how environmental stimuli influence an individual's internal psychological state, which in turn gives rise to a behavioural response.

In the context of digital marketing, the S-O-R framework has frequently been used to explain how the online environment and marketing content influence consumers' perceptions and purchasing behaviour. Extrinsic factors, such as website design, marketing communication and communication behavior, have been shown by previous studies to have an impact on consumers ' internal thinking processes, especially emotions, attitudes, and value judgments (Eroglu et al., 2001; Li and Zhang, 2002). Purchase intention and other behaviors are also influenced by such internal cognition, which can be seen.

2.10 Previous Research Related to Social Media Marketing Content and Purchase Intention

Factors such as trust, honesty, clarity and professionalism of information, and value propositions have been pointed out by the existing literature to play a key role in purchasing decisions after product recognition and advertising viewing. Table 2.1 summarizes several core studies focusing on this correlation in the context of digital purchase. On the whole, factors such as credibility, authenticity, information quality

and diagnosticity, and entertainment have a significant impact on the individual 's perception of the product and its response to advertising.

If the marketing materials are credible and authentic, the trust bond among consumers, brands and marketers will be strengthened. The enhancement of trust relationship is regarded as the key to stimulate purchase intention (Lim et al., 2017; Lou & Yuan, 2019; Saima & Khan, 2020). The specific and timely information contained in the video helps consumers to evaluate the value of the product more effectively, deepen their understanding of the value, and support their purchase judgment (Filieri, 2015; Jiang & Benbasat, 2007). It can be seen from the example that the more detailed and timely such information is, the clearer consumers ' grasp of product value is, and the decision-making process is also optimized.

Individual factors such as attitude and brand cognition are emphasized by some scholars as the core variables affecting purchase intention (Filieri, 2015; Jiang & Benbasat, 2007). In the context of short videos, if the content is both attractive and informative, it can establish a close connection with the audience and promote their purchase behavior (Meng et al., 2024; Liu & Wang, 2023). Other studies have pointed out that individual-level attitudes and brand awareness play a decisive role in determining whether users are exposed to specific brands through social media (Lu et al., 2016; Wang et al., 2022).

It can be seen that the quality of marketing video first affects consumers ' emotion and cognition of the product and then directly or indirectly shapes their purchase intention.

Table 2.1 Previous Research Related to Social Media Marketing Content and Purchase Intention

No.	Author (Year)	Dependent Variable	Independent Variable	Research Findings
1	Lim, X. J., Radzol, A. R., Cheah, J. H., & Wong, M. W. (2017)	Purchase Intention	Influencer Credibility	Influencer credibility significantly influences consumers' purchase intentions in social media marketing.
2	Saima, & Khan, M. A. (2020)	Purchase Intention	Influencer Credibility	The credibility of influencers positively affects consumers' responses to advertising and increases purchase intention.

3	Lou, C., & Yuan, S. (2019)	Purchase Intention	Influencer Credibility, Authenticity, Informativeness	Authentic and credible influencer content enhances trust and positively influences consumers' purchase intentions.
4	Filieri, R. (2015)	Purchase Intention	Information Quality	High-quality online information improves consumers' product evaluations and increases purchase intention.
5	Jiang, Z., & Benbasat, I. (2007)	Purchase Intention	Diagnostic Information	Diagnostic information helps consumers evaluate product attributes more effectively and supports purchasing decisions.
6	Meng, L., Kou, S., Duan, S., & Bie, Y. (2024)	Purchase Intention	Trustworthiness, Expertise, Attractiveness, Authenticity, Brand Heritage	Influencer characteristics significantly influence consumer perceptions and purchase intentions in short-video marketing environments.
7	Liu, Y., & Wang, Y. (2023)	Purchase Intention	Entertainment and Informational Content	Video content combining entertainment and informational value increases user engagement and enhances purchase intention.
8	Lu, B., Fan, W., & Zhou, M. (2016)	Purchase Intention	Trust	Trust in social commerce platforms significantly influences consumers' purchase intentions.
9	Wang, J., Shahzad, F., Ahmad, Z., Abdullah, M., & Hassan, N. M. (2022)	Purchase Intention	Trust, Perceived Value	Trust and perceived value positively influence consumers' purchase intentions in digital commerce environments.

10	Liu, Z., & Liu, Y. (2018)	Purchase Intention	Platform Characteristics, Perceived Risk	Platform characteristics and perceived risk influence consumers' purchase intentions in cross-border e-commerce.
11	Zhu, W., Mou, J., & Benyoucef, M. (2019)	Purchase Intention	Perceived Risk	Perceived risk negatively influences consumers' purchase intentions in cross-border online shopping.
12	Ayob, N. H., et al. (2024)	Purchase Intention	Social Media Engagement, Peer Influence	Social media engagement and peer influence significantly influence Malaysian consumers' online purchase intentions.

2.11 Literature Gap

Although previous studies have provided some important insights into social media marketing and online consumption, there are still many significant gaps in the existing literature. Focusing on traditional platforms such as Instagram, Facebook, or YouTube constitutes the main body of most previous studies. The specific impact of TikTok on consumer behavior has not been fully explored. This omission is significant because the algorithm recommendation system TikTok relies on creates a marketing environment that is very different from the previous platforms (Zulli & Zulli, 2020).

In addition to platform characteristics, research on Internet celebrity marketing often focuses more on the personal characteristics of creators, such as affinity or authenticity, rather than the actual quality of the product content itself. The immediacy of short videos is particularly prominent on TikTok and the presentation mode and overall aesthetics have become the key factors affecting consumer cognition (Meng et al., 2024). This shift in user perception highlights the importance of other attributes: credibility, authenticity, quality of information, diagnosticity, and entertainment, all of which shape the audience's response.

The continuous growth of cross-border trade on social media has further aggravated the difficulty of understanding the above relationship. Although this phenomenon is widespread around the world, researchers pay little attention to it. The complexity introduced by international trade in terms of fairness and benefit sharing makes psychological factors such as trust and perceived value more critical.

The stimulus-organism-response (S-O-R) model (Eroglu et al., 2001) has been widely used as a framework to explain consumer behavior in the digital world. It is still rare to effectively integrate the inherent characteristics of TikTok content with such cognitive processes in a single model. This study explores the above aspects by examining how TikTok's global marketing affects Malaysian consumers ' trust, perceived value and purchase intention of Chinese products.

Chapter 3 Literature Review

3.1 Variable Selection and Description

In this study, drawing on the Stimulus-Organism-Response (S-O-R) model and previous research in the field of social media marketing, we identified several variables to analyse the influence of marketing content on TikTok on consumers' purchase intentions regarding cross-border e-commerce products in China. More specifically, we conceptualised content credibility, content authenticity, information quality, diagnosticity and entertainment as stimulus variables representing the characteristics of marketing content on TikTok. Trust and perceived value are treated as organism variables reflecting the consumer's internal psychological reaction to the content. Purchase intention is considered a response variable representing the consumer's behavioural intention. Furthermore, to examine whether the consumer's prior experience with international online shopping influences the relationship between trust and purchase intention, cross-border shopping experience is included as a moderating variable. The following sections describe each of these variables in detail.

3.1.1 Content Credibility

Consumers regard marketing communication as a trustworthy, persuasive and acceptable way, which is called content credibility. In the social media environment, because it is impossible to experience products before purchase, it often relies on digital information for decision-making. Online information credibility, thus, is one of the key factors affecting consumer decision-making. Previous research examples show that when marketing materials are deemed credible, consumers are more likely to accept the information they present and form a more positive view of the products they promote (Lou and Yuan, 2019; Saima and Khan, 2020).

In the context of TikTok marketing, trust acts on consumers ' perception of product video and their judgment of the credibility of video promoters.

3.1.2 Content Authenticity

The authenticity of the product is understood as the degree of truth, nature and sincerity in the perception. Natural and personalized products are more favored by consumers than over-commercialized ones. It can be seen that the importance of authentic communication in social media marketing is constantly increasing. According to the

research of Lou and Yuan (2019), the authentic communication conducted by authoritative bloggers can create a sense of transparency for consumers and enhance their trust in the promoted brands. On the TikTok platform, product promotion is mostly carried out in the form of personal stories, product demonstrations and user-generated content (UGC). Such forms highlight the authenticity of the content and have an impact on consumers ' perception of product promotion.

3.1.3 Information Quality

Information quality refers to the performance of information provided to consumers in terms of accuracy, completeness, and clarity. In the context of online shopping, if the information has higher quality, the buyer's grasp of the product characteristics will be more sufficient and the uncertainty faced in the decision-making process will also be reduced. Studies have shown that if the information is clear and practical, consumers ' ability to evaluate products will be improved and their confidence in online purchase decisions will be enhanced (Filieri, 2015). If the product video on the TikTok platform contains detailed description, actual demonstration and user evaluation, consumers ' understanding of the product will be more in-depth, and the cognition of the products promoted by the advertisement will be affected.

3.1.4 Diagnosticity

Consumers ' evaluation of product quality and the formation of purchase decisions often depend on product information. In the digital environment, the diagnostic information is particularly prominent because of the inability to directly contact physical objects. What Jiang and Benbasat (2007) emphasize is the key to the demonstration of demonstration products. Such demonstrations can provide heuristic paths to assist consumers to judge product attributes more effectively and alleviate the uncertainty they face. On the TikTok platform, diagnostic information is often conveyed through presentations, comparisons with other products, or presentations of daily use situations, enabling consumers to build personal perceptions of product style and quality.

3.1.5 Entertainment Value

Entertainment value refers to the degree of interest, attraction and emotion aroused by marketing materials in the audience 's heart. On short video platforms such as TikTok, it is often used to grab users ' attention, with attractive elements such as music, humor, narrative and creative editing skills.

The improvement of users ' participation can be promoted by entertaining marketing content, and consumers ' perception of the promotion information conveyed by products and their advertisements is also affected by it (Meng et al., 2024; Liu & Wang, 2023).

If the marketing content is too much emphasis on entertainment, the information clues needed to evaluate product quality may be ignored. The entertainment of videos, rather than product-related information, is more likely to become the focus of consumers ' attention. Examples can be seen in many user behavior observations.

The importance of the information provided may be weakened by excessive reliance on entertainment content and consumers ' ability to evaluate the value of the product is also limited. The perceived value of advertising products may be affected by negative effects.

3.1.6 Trust

The trust held by the buyer is reflected in the belief that the product or seller is trustworthy, honest and trustworthy and fulfills the commitment. In the context of e-commerce, this trust is particularly critical, because customers cannot visit the scene to check the quality of goods or verify the seller 's integrity. The research example of Lu et al. (2016) shows that trust plays a significant role in weakening perceived risk and influencing customers ' willingness to conduct online transactions. When customers purchase goods promoted by overseas sellers in TikTok cross-border trade scenarios, their decision-making process is significantly affected by trust.

3.1.7 Perceived Value

The overall evaluation formed by customers after weighing the advantages of products and their prices is called 'perceived value '. Zeithaml (1988) has pointed out that this value is reflected in a state of balance between perceived advantage and perceived effort. If the product is recognized by the customer as having a good cost performance, or can bring practical and useful advantages, it is more likely to have a positive attitude towards it. In the context of digital marketing, the information conveyed by online content and the experience created by it have a significant impact on perceived value, which shows that there are many examples.

3.1.8 Purchase Intention

Customers are likely or certain to purchase a particular product in the future, which is the meaning of purchase intention. It can be seen that the purchase intention is reflected in the future purchase possibility of a specific product. It is widely used in

consumer behaviour research as an indicator of potential purchasing behaviour. Previous studies have shown that purchase intention is influenced by various psychological factors, such as trust, perceived value and attitudes towards marketing channels (Chen and Lin, 2019). In this study, purchase intention refers to consumers' willingness to purchase Chinese products advertised via marketing channels on TikTok.

3.1.9 Cross-border Shopping Experience

The term 'cross-border shopping experience' refers to the previous experiences of consumers who have purchased products from overseas sellers via online platforms. Consumers with experience of cross-border trade may be more familiar with the international delivery process, payment systems and the potential risks associated with shopping abroad. Compared with customers who have not had similar experiences, their perception of cross-border marketing information is different (Zhu, Mou and Benyoucef, 2019). Customers with rich online shopping experience feel less uncertainty when shopping online and show a higher degree of trust in online transactions, which has been confirmed by previous studies (Gefen, 2000).

In the context of cross-border e-commerce, this experience is placed after the interpretation of marketing information and the evaluation of seller credibility.

The relationship between trust and purchase intention can be seen to be regulated by cross-border shopping experience, so this study regards it as an intermediary variable.

3.2 Research Framework

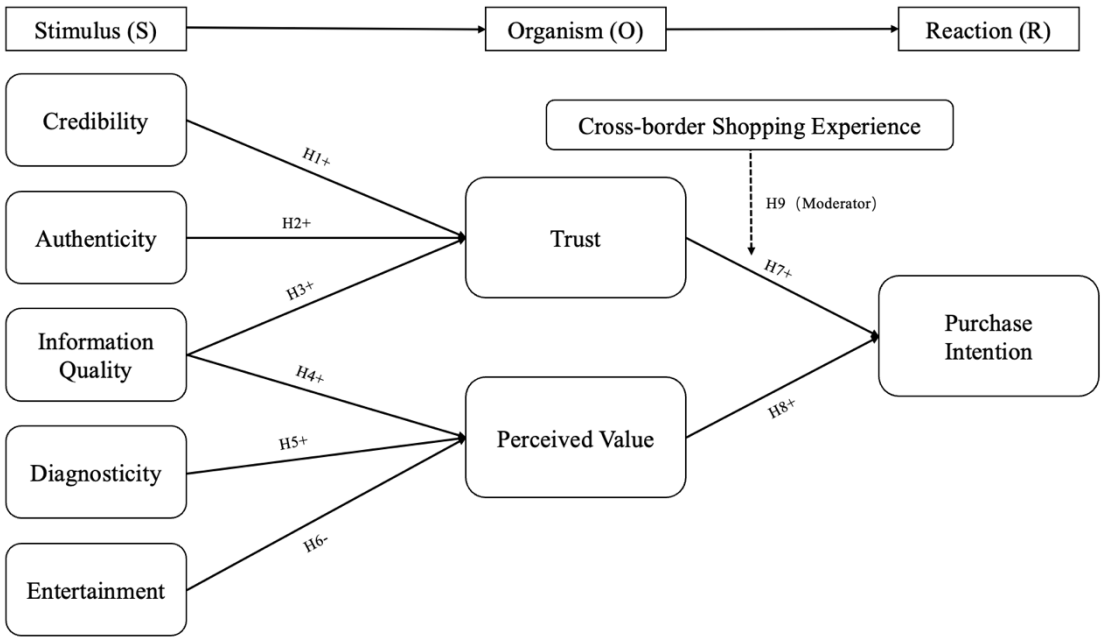


Figure 3.1 Research Framework

3.3 Hypothesis Development

3.3.1 Content Credibility and Consumer Trust

Whether consumers regard marketing communication as credible and true depends on the credibility of the information itself. In the digital space, people rely entirely on online information. At this time, the concept of credibility is particularly critical to the shaping of their overall cognition. When the video or text shows high credibility, the audience is more likely to trust the potential purchase objects presented in it and the trust in the product or the seller is also enhanced.

Many studies have supported this view, emphasizing that trust should be the foundation of social media marketing communication.

Lou and Yuan (2019) found that if the content created by online celebrities is perceived as credible, consumers ' trust in the promoted brand will increase significantly. Saima and Khan (2020) also confirmed that if the information has credible characteristics, it can enhance the audience's trust in it, thereby strengthening the actual effect of online celebrity marketing.

For TikTok users, advertisements mostly appear in the form of short videos made by creators or brands. Because it is difficult for the audience to independently verify the authenticity of the content claimed in the video, they often judge whether the product is reliable quickly based on the credibility of the video itself.

When the information is presented in a factual and documentary way, it conveys a credible signal to consumers, making the products displayed more credible. It follows that the following assumptions are made :

H1: Content credibility positively influences consumer trust toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.

3.3.2 Content Authenticity and Consumer Trust

The credibility, naturalness and sincerity of marketing materials in the eyes of customers are determined by the authenticity of their content. In the social media environment, this factor constitutes an important basis for people to judge advertisements.

Generally speaking, consumers are more inclined to choose video content with personal color and seem real and natural, rather than batch output or similar to traditional TV advertising. The study found that authenticity constitutes the core driving force for obtaining customer trust. Once the marketing content shows the real and

natural characteristics, rather than the simple advertising form, its authentic will increase.

Lou and Yuan (2019) have pointed out that when the media content posted by online celebrities has the characteristics of authenticity and credibility, the brand's honest and transparent image is strengthened, thus contributing to a direct trust relationship with consumers.

Audrezet et al. (2018) also emphasized that ' intimacy ' constitutes a key element in the dissemination of online celebrities, because audiences tend to be more willing to rely on creators who present themselves and their products in a friendly and approachable way.

On the TikTok platform, products are mostly presented by personal narratives, short presentations, or videos taken by ordinary users. When the audience perceives the sincere attitude of the creator, the level of trust in the characters and the products displayed in the video also increases accordingly. Therefore, authenticity becomes the basic premise of building trust in the process of promoting international products for TikTok users. Based on the above examples, the following assumptions are made :

H2: Content authenticity positively influences consumer trust toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.

3.3.3 Information Quality and Consumer Trust

Information quality refers to the degree to which the detailed content presented to the buyer is accurate, clear and complete. In the context of online shopping, consumers can 't contact or check the goods by hand before purchasing and can only rely on the content of digital form to make judgments. It can be seen that providing high-level information has become an important part of building consumer trust. Existing research on online shopping has pointed out that if information is both accurate and detailed, it can effectively alleviate uncertainty and enhance customer confidence. Filieri (2015) observed that when the online product description quality is high, the user's trust level in the content increases, and it is more likely to adopt the suggestions given in the video or article. The research of Jiang and Benbasat (2007) also shows that if the product display is clear and accurate, the customer 's understanding of its characteristics is more sufficient, thus showing a stronger sense of trust and more positive evaluation.

On the TikTok platform, sellers often use short video to convey product information, demonstrating its operation mode and the benefits it brings. If the video

content is easy to understand and rich in practical information, it is easier for users to evaluate the product and trust the content conveyed. Information quality is thus regarded as a key factor affecting consumers ' trust in international goods sold by the platform. Based on this, the following assumptions are made :

H3: Information quality positively influences consumer trust toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.

3.3.4 Information Quality and Perceived Value

In addition to the role of information quality in trust, it also has an impact on the buyer 's evaluation of the perceived value of the product. The overall judgment is made by the individual. Based on the expected income, it measures whether the product value meets its own needs, which is the so-called perceived value of the product.

When the information transmitted by the video is of high quality, it helps the audience to understand the product operation mechanism and benefits. If the information is clear and practical, it often makes the product show higher value, which is more likely to stimulate the purchase intention.

Some studies have pointed out that if advertising is rich in information, it can enhance the perceived value of products in consumers ' minds, because it can reduce uncertainty and promote their decision-making more confident (Fan et al., 2024).

On the TikTok platform, videos that simply describe the product's purpose or function are enough to help viewers determine whether the product is actually helpful in their daily lives.

It can be seen that the improvement of information quality helps to enhance the Malaysian audience 's recognition of the perceived value of global Chinese products. Accordingly, the following recommendations are made :

H4: Information quality positively influences perceived value toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.

3.3.5 Diagnosticity and Perceived Value

Diagnostic ability refers to the role of information in product quality assessment and purchase decision-making. In the context of online shopping, consumers cannot directly contact or try out goods, so they attach great importance to information that helps product judgment.

Jiang and Benbasat (2007) pointed out that if the product is accompanied by a clear description that is easy to evaluate, the buyer will give such information a higher diagnostic value, which is easier to form a judgment on the quality of the product. Filieri (2015) also found that practical information can enhance the relevance of online content and enhance consumers ' trust in quality assessment.

On the TikTok platform, content with diagnostic features is often reflected in the display of product use process, presentation of ' before and after comparison ', out-of-the-box video or on-site testing. Such videos provide visual evidence to help the audience accurately grasp the product operation mode and its adaptation degree. Because these contents help to understand the actual benefits of the product, the stronger the expected diagnosticity, the higher the perceived value of the product. Accordingly, the following assumptions are made :

H5: Information diagnosticity positively influences perceived value toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.

3.3.6 Entertainment Value and Perceived Value

Entertainment value refers to the degree of pleasure, willingness to participate and emotional involvement brought by marketing content to the audience. TikTok, as a representative of the platform, is known for its content rich in such qualities, which is often constructed with music, jokes, creative editing and narrative techniques. Videos are more focused on entertainment effects, and product information transmission is weakened. It is difficult for buyers to judge whether the product is really easy to use.

In terms of attracting attention and promoting digital media interaction, entertainment videos have achieved remarkable results (Meng et al., 2024). The maintenance of user interest and the improvement of content perception can also be achieved in short video marketing through humor elements (Liu and Wang, 2023).

However, if the content only focuses on the purpose of entertainment, the practicality is often sacrificed and it has surface attraction. Once the video overemphasizes entertainment or blindly pursues the trend, it is difficult to provide consumers with clear guidance to understand the actual benefits of the product. The audience is in trouble and cannot judge whether the product is worth buying from the practical dimension.

In TikTok 's international marketing practice, a large number of videos tend to follow viral trends or tell interesting stories, rather than accurately present product functions. Although such content is highly ornamental and eye-catching, it is hardly helpful for product quality evaluation. If entertainment is overemphasized, the perceived value of the product may decline, because the audience cannot fully grasp its actual use. It follows that the following assumptions are made :

H6: Entertainment value negatively influences perceived value toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.

3.3.7 Consumer Trust and Purchase Intention

Consumer trust is a key factor in online shopping decisions, especially in cross-border situations. Sellers are in other countries and the uncertainty presented by buyers is often more significant. The conviction of transaction security and the judgment that the products received are consistent with the commitment often appear after the establishment of consumer trust.

As an indicator to predict individuals ' purchase intention on social media platforms, the research results of trust are highly convergent. The empirical results of Lu et al. (2016) show that the purchase tendency of social media recommended products is significantly affected by trust. Wang et al. (2022) also pointed out that in the social e-commerce environment, the dominant factor of purchase intention is trust.

On the TikTok platform, users rely more on video creators and product displays to determine the quality of goods. If the information is regarded as credible by the audience and has trust in the seller or brand, the purchase intention is easier to express clearly. Without this sense of security and credibility, purchase decisions are usually difficult to form. It follows that the following assumptions are made :

H7: Consumer trust positively influences purchase intention toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.

3.3.8 Perceived Value and Purchase Intention

Another important factor that affects consumers ' purchase decisions is perceived value. When a product is perceived by consumers to bring significant benefits, the tendency to buy the product is often more pronounced relative to its price, or relative to the effort required to obtain the product. It can be seen that if the benefits are prominent, the purchase intention may be enhanced.

This idea has been studied extensively in marketing. Zeithaml (1988) described perceived value as a person's overall judgment of how useful a product is, based on the balance between what they get and what they have to give up (like money or time). Recent research on social media shopping also confirms that when people feel they are getting a good deal, they develop a stronger purchase intention (Fan et al., 2024).
In TikTok's international marketing, Malaysian consumers judge the value of products from China by looking at things like low prices, how well the product works, and how useful it seems. If the viewer believes the product is a good find for the price, they are much more likely to form a purchase intention. Therefore, the following hypothesis is proposed:

H8: Perceived value positively influences purchase intention toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.

3.3.9 Moderating Role of Cross-border Shopping Experience

Cross-border shopping experience refers to the historical records accumulated by individuals through the Internet to purchase foreign merchants. Such past experience may affect the buyer 's perception of risk, the level of trust in the seller and the way in which the purchase decision is made. Compared with local shopping, international shopping is often more complex and accompanied by more significant uncertainties, such as longer delivery cycles, doubtful product quality and cumbersome return policies.

Some studies have pointed out that buyers with more cross-border shopping experience often show a higher degree of peace of mind about international distribution and payment processes. With this kind of cognition, they often show stronger self-confidence when trying new products and making decisions. Lu and Chen (2021) proposed that previous online shopping experience helps to alleviate hesitation and encourage individuals to adjust the method of evaluating purchase decisions. For such experienced consumers, because they are more familiar with the overseas shopping process, the dependence of their purchase intention on trust signals may be relatively weakened.

On the contrary, those with little cross-border shopping experience usually rely more on a sense of trust when judging whether to place an order with an overseas seller. At this time, trust becomes a key factor in making it feel safe enough to complete the purchase. It can be seen that the level of experience that consumers have, or the weight of adjustable trust in their final purchase intention.

H9: Cross-border shopping experience moderates the relationship between consumer trust and purchase intention toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.

3.4 Summary of Hypothesis

H1: Content credibility positively influences trust.

H2: Content authenticity positively influences trust.

H3: Information quality positively influences trust.

H4: Information quality positively influences perceived value.

H5: Diagnosticity positively influences perceived value.

H6: Entertainment value negatively influences perceived value.

H7: Trust positively influences purchase intention.

H8: Perceived value positively influences purchase intention.

H9: Cross-border shopping experience moderates the relationship between trust and purchase intention.

3.5 Chapter Summary

In this chapter, we present the theoretical framework of this study, which is based on the Stimulus-Organism-Response model (S-O-R model). Within this framework, we conceptualise the relationships between the characteristics of TikTok content, consumers' psychological responses and their purchase intentions. Specifically, we have identified content credibility, content authenticity, information quality, diagnosticity and entertainment value as stimulus variables and trust and perceived value as organismic variables that influence consumers' purchase intentions.

Based on a literature review, nine hypotheses were formulated to explain the relationships between these concepts. Furthermore, the cross-border purchasing experience was introduced as a moderating variable that influences the relationship between trust and purchase intention.

The proposed research framework and hypotheses form the theoretical basis for the empirical analysis presented in the next chapter.

In the next chapter, we explain the methodology applied in this study, which encompasses the study design, the sampling method, the development of the questionnaire, the measurement of variables and the data analysis procedure.

Chapter 4 Research Method

4.1 Research Design

This study uses quantitative methods to examine the impact of TikTok international marketing on Malaysian consumers ' willingness to purchase Chinese products. This method is widely used in the field of marketing because it uses mathematical and statistical methods to analyze the correlation between variables. To reveal this association, the stimulus-organism-response (S-O-R) model was introduced into the analytical framework.

How the stimulus in the environment acts on the individual's internal perception and promotes subsequent behavior is explained by the S-O-R model. In this study, the stimulus source is reflected in the characteristics of TikTok video, such as credibility, authenticity, information quality, diagnosticity and entertainment value. The specific details and personal feelings obtained by users when watching product videos in the application are reflected by the above characteristics.

The two key intrinsic feelings - trust and perceived value- are expected to be changed by the above stimuli. The former refers to the buyer's determination that the seller is honest and reliable and the latter represents that the product is considered to be worth the money. Purchase intention is the final result of such feelings. The moderating effect of cross-border shopping experience is also included in the study. Whether or not such experience affects the actual role of trust in purchasing decisions will become the focus of analysis.

The cross-sectional study will be used for data collection, and the information of respondents will be obtained at a specific time point. This legal system explores the conventional path of consumers ' views and their future intentions. In view of the fact that this study focuses on the feelings of individuals after watching TikTok content, the questionnaire survey is considered to be the most feasible way to collect information.

4.2 Sampling and Data Collection

This study focuses on Malaysian TikTok users who have watched videos promoting Chinese products. In recent years, TikTok has been established as an important platform for international marketing. Merchants and content creators often

display products through short videos and live broadcasts. It can be seen that many Malaysian users will naturally come into contact with such advertising content in the process of using the application.

Because TikTok users have no official directory to follow, this study uses non-probabilistic sampling. Specifically, judgment sampling is implemented to ensure that the selected participants meet the criteria set by the study. Respondents must meet two conditions at the same time : first, they must be active users of TikTok ; secondly, he has watched TikTok videos promoting Chinese products.

In the initial stage of the survey, there is a pre-screening question to confirm whether the respondents meet the above two conditions.

In order to expand the sample coverage, the snowball sampling method was also included. Those who completed the questionnaire were invited to forward the link to relatives and friends who also used the application. Examples show that this method helps researchers to contact more people with similar TikTok marketing experience.

Data collection relies on Tencent questionnaire platform to carry out online survey. Online tools are widely used in social media research because they can quickly reach user groups in different regions. Survey links are disseminated through social media applications and personal social networks. Participation was entirely voluntary and all respondents were informed that their answers would be anonymous and used only for academic research purposes.

The target sample size was set at 200 to 300 valid questionnaires. This number can meet the basic requirements of the statistical method (PLS-SEM) used in this study. According to the relevant research guidelines, the sample size should be no less than ten times the number of paths pointing to a single latent variable in the model. Therefore, 201 valid responses were considered to be sufficient to support subsequent reliable and accurate data analysis.

4.3 Questionnaire Design

The data were collected through a well-structured questionnaire, which adopted the evaluation scale commonly used in scientific research. The application of the maturity scale helps to improve the effectiveness and reliability of the results. The wording of some items is slightly adjusted to fit the TikTok marketing context. The questionnaire is divided into three main parts :

- The first part: The questions used to screen respondents who meet the research qualifications are placed in this section. Whether to use TikTok, whether to have watched a video showing Chinese products, to confirm the content.
- Second part: Basic personal information such as age, gender and education level is collected here. It also asks about the frequency of use of TikTok and whether it has ever purchased Chinese products from the platform. The characteristics of the interviewed group can be presented more clearly.
- The final stage: the most critical part of the survey is here. Participants need to recall a recent TikTok video about Chinese products before answering. The feedback content covers factors such as credibility, authenticity, information value, diagnosticity and entertainment value. Trust, perceived value, purchase intention and cross-border shopping experience behavior are also taken into account.

In order to maintain the consistency of answers, all questions were in the form of a 5-point scale. One point indicated 'extremely disagree ' and five points corresponded to 'extremely agree '. This kind of scale is more common in the field of social science because it is convenient for respondents to express their recognition of the statement. The above content is mostly cited from existing well-known studies and made appropriate adjustments according to the TikTok life situation.

4.4 Variable Measurements

After an in-depth analysis of the previous research, the components of this study were formulated and the accuracy and relevance of the problem setting were guaranteed. A comprehensive method is adopted and each variable is divided into different categories and the precise concept that fits the research goal is thus formed. In order to clearly present the variables to be evaluated, the specific concepts adopted by each factor are listed in Table 4.1. A more in-depth analysis of the relevant characteristics of each variable shows the benefits of this methodological approach.

Table 4.1 Variable Measurement Table

Variable	Code	Measurement Statement	Sources

Content Credibility (CC)	CC1	The TikTok content about Chinese products is credible.	Lou & Yuan (2019); Saima & Khan (2020)
	CC2	I believe the information presented in these TikTok videos.	
	CC3	The product-related content on TikTok seems trustworthy.	
	CC4	The TikTok creator appears knowledgeable about the product.	
Content Authenticity (CA)	CA1	The TikTok content feels genuine.	Lou & Yuan (2019)
	CA2	The creator honestly shares their experience with the product.	
	CA3	The product demonstration appears realistic.	
	CA4	The content does not seem overly staged.	
Information Quality (IQ)	IQ1	The TikTok content provides clear product information.	Filieri (2015); Jiang & Benbasat (2007)
	IQ2	The information in the video is accurate.	
	IQ3	The content provides sufficient details about the product.	
	IQ4	The information is useful for evaluating the product.	

Diagnosticity (DI)	DI1	The TikTok video helps me judge the product quality.	Jiang & Benbasat (2007)
	DI2	The content helps me make a purchase decision.	
	DI3	The product presentation makes evaluation easier.	
Entertainment Value (EV)	EV1	The TikTok content is entertaining.	Meng et al. (2024); Liu & Wang (2023)
	EV2	Watching the video is enjoyable.	
	EV3	The video is fun to watch.	
	EV4	The content captures my attention.	
Trust (TR)	TR1	I trust the seller of the Chinese product.	Lu et al. (2016); Wang et al. (2022)
	TR2	I believe the seller is honest.	
	TR3	I feel confident about buying this product.	
	TR4	I think the seller keeps promises.	
Perceived Value (PV)	PV1	The product offers good value for money.	Zeithaml (1988); Fan et al. (2024)
	PV2	The product is worth its price.	

	PV3	The product is beneficial to me.	
	PV4	Overall, the product is valuable.	
Purchase Intention (PI)	PI1	I intend to purchase Chinese products through TikTok.	Chen & Lin (2019); Ajzen (1991)
	PI2	I am likely to buy such products in the future.	
	PI3	I would consider purchasing after watching TikTok videos.	
Cross-border Shopping Experience (CB)	CB1	I have prior experience purchasing cross-border products.	Lu & Chen (2021)
	CB2	I am familiar with cross-border online shopping.	
	CB3	I often buy products from overseas sellers.	

4.5 Measurement of Variables

The measurement tools used in this study are adapted from the validated scales in the existing literature. Reliable and effective conceptual measures, facilitated by such tools derived from recognized research.

The setting of credibility and authenticity indicators refers to Lou and Yuan (2019) and Saima and Khan (2020) ' s discussion on online celebrity marketing. Consumers ' attitudes towards and trust in promotional products are significantly influenced by the credibility and authenticity of social media content, which is an example revealed by the above research.

The construct of information quality and diagnostic information value is based on the results of Filieri (2015) and Jiang and Benbasat (2007). The ability of users to

evaluate products and form purchasing decisions is influenced by the practicality and comprehensibility of online information, which can be seen in their research findings.

The dimension of entertainment value is quoted from the discussion of short video marketing effect by Meng et al. (2024) and Liu and Wang (2023).

The trust measurement project, based on the items proposed by Lu et al. (2016) and Wang et al. (2022), focuses on the construction process of trust in the context of social e-commerce.

The operational definition of perceived value is rooted in the consumer value theory proposed by Zeithaml (1988) and integrates the latest application of Fan et al. (2024) in the field of short video marketing.

The measurement of purchase intention is based on the scale revised by Chen and Lin (2019) and Ajzen (1991). The characteristics of consumer purchase behavior in live broadcast and social e-commerce environments are the core of its research.

The cross-border shopping experience is measured by the scale of respondents ' familiarity with cross-border online shopping and their past experience (Lu and Chen, 2021). All measurement items and their corresponding sources are summarized in Table 4.1.

4.6 Data Analysis Method

After the data collection, the questionnaire responses were analyzed by statistical software. The whole analysis process is divided into two stages.

In the first stage, SPSS software was used to conduct a preliminary examination of the data and conduct descriptive statistical analysis. The work of this stage includes : verification of the existence of missing values, identification of potential outliers and generalization of the demographic characteristics of respondents. The respondents ' cognition of the concept of measurement in this study is also grasped through descriptive statistics.

In the second stage, the structural relationship proposed in the research framework was verified by partial least squares structural equation model (PLS-SEM). The analysis was completed by SmartPLS software. In the field of marketing and information systems, PLS-SEM is widely used because it has good adaptability to complex models with multiple latent variables and does not require data to obey normal distribution.

Model evaluation includes two parts: measurement model and structural model. The former focuses on the reliability and validity test of the concept. In terms of reliability, the Cronbach's coefficient and composite reliability (CR) were adopted; the convergent validity was judged by extracting the average variance extracted (AVE). The discriminant validity was based on the Fornell-Larcker criterion.

After the measurement model meets the established standards, the structural model evaluation is carried out immediately. The test of the hypothesis relationship between variables is realized by path coefficient estimation. The statistical significance of these relationships is determined by bootstrapping. The explanatory power of the model is measured by the coefficient of determination (R^2), the effect size (f^2) and the predictive power (Q^2).

Trust and perceived value, as mediating variables, play a role in the process of TikTok content characteristics affecting purchase intention and are also included in the model. The moderating effect of cross-border shopping experience on the relationship between trust and purchase intention is also discussed in the study.

Chapter 5 Data Analysis

5.1 Data Scale

The online survey was conducted between February 15 and March 17, 2026. A total of 243 valid questionnaires were collected in the initial stage. Through the screening process, 42 copies were eliminated according to the following criteria :

- If the completion time is too short or too long, it is considered that the response time is unreasonable and excluded to ensure data quality.
- All the questionnaires with the same answers in the items of the scale were judged to be invalid because they reflected that the respondents did not answer carefully.
- Participants who had not used TikTok or had not been exposed to content related to the promotion of Chinese products were also screened out because they did not match the target group of this study.

Finally, 201 valid questionnaires were retained, with an effective rate of about 82.72 %. It can be seen that the samples are highly representative. The example shows that the elimination standard has a practical effect on improving data reliability.

5.2 Descriptive Statistical Analysis

5.2.1 Sample Statistical Characteristics

This section presents the demographic characteristics of the respondents, such as gender, age, frequency of TikTok use and purchase history.

Table 5.1 Respondent Characteristics

Variable	Sample Characteristics	Frequency	Percentages(%)
Gender	Female	138	68.7
	Male	63	31.3
Age	18-24	151	75.1
	25-34	46	22.9
	35-44	0	0
	44 and above	4	2.0

Frequency of TikTok Use	Daily	93	46.3
	Several times a week	45	22.4
	Occasionally	63	31.3
Past Buy	Yes	103	51.2
	No	98	48.8

As can be seen from Table 5.1, female respondents are the majority 68.7 %, while male respondents account for 31.3%, and the sample composition is dominated by women.

In terms of age distribution, 18 to 24 years old accounted for the majority, accounting for 75.1% of the total sample; followed by 25 to 34 years old group, accounting for 22.9%; only 2.0 % of respondents aged 45 years and above were recorded, while no respondents were recorded in the 35-44 age range. It can be seen that this study mainly reflects the situation of young users.

In terms of the frequency of TikTok usage, daily users account for 46.3% and the high participation of the platform can be seen. The number of users per week accounted for 22.4% and the proportion of occasional users was 31.3%. In terms of past shopping experience, 51.2% have shopped and 48.8 % have never shopped. The proportion of the two types of users is close to equilibrium.

In summary, the sample subject is young and active TikTok users, which makes it suitable as the object group of TikTok marketing and consumer purchase intention related research.

5.2.2 Descriptive Analysis of Each Variable

The descriptive statistical analysis of each variable is implemented in this study. The standard deviation of all variables is less than 2, the data dispersion is not large and the relative consistency can be seen. The distribution of the survey results is relatively concentrated, which is suitable for further statistical analysis. The specific results are as follows :

Table 5.2 Descriptive Statistical Analysis of Each Variable

Variable	N	Mean	Std.Deviation
Content Credibility	201	3.36	0.80

Content Authenticity	201	3.31	0.82
Information Quality	201	3.55	0.79
Diagnosticity	201	3.75	0.88
Entertainment Value	201	4.09	0.75
Trust	201	3.27	0.84
Perceived Value	201	3.58	0.77
Purchase Intention	201	3.45	1.05
Cross-border shopping experience	201	3.88	1.05

5.3 Inferential Statistical Analysis

In order to ensure the quality of the data obtained throughout the study, it is necessary to measure the model analysis. This step is often called ' external model verification '. In this analysis, the data were evaluated according to two core criteria: reliability and validity. The function of consistency check is carried out by reliability, which is used to confirm whether the questionnaire items can produce stable and repeatable results when they are tested in the same situation. The responsibility of applicability test is performed by validity, which is used to judge whether the item can really measure the specific variables to be examined. It can be seen that the consistency and applicability are verified at the same time to ensure that the collected information is reliable and suitable for further analysis.

5.3.1 Convergent Validity Test

Convergence validity refers to the degree to which the index group reflects a single concept. In this study, the external load coefficient of each item of the scale was analyzed to evaluate the convergent validity. Hair et al. (2019) pointed out that the external load coefficient needs to exceed 0.70 to indicate that the index is sufficiently reliable. The results listed in Table 5.3 show that the external load coefficients of all projects are higher than the recommended threshold and the values are between 0.724 and 0.972. It can be seen that all measurement items are reliable and properly reflect their corresponding concepts.

Table 5.3 Outer Loading Value

Construct	Item	Outer Loading	Evaluation
Content Credibility	CC1	0.846	Valid
	CC2	0.876	Valid
	CC3	0.884	Valid
	CC4	0.724	Valid
Content Authenticity	CA1	0.809	Valid
	CA2	0.818	Valid
	CA3	0.876	Valid
	CA4	0.806	Valid
Information Quality	IQ1	0.826	Valid
	IQ2	0.803	Valid
	IQ3	0.874	Valid
	IQ4	0.817	Valid
Diagnosticity	DI1	0.854	Valid
	DI2	0.902	Valid
	DI3	0.885	Valid
Entertainment Value	EV1	0.792	Valid
	EV2	0.874	Valid
	EV3	0.906	Valid
	EV4	0.878	Valid
Trust	TR1	0.867	Valid
	TR2	0.894	Valid
	TR3	0.972	Valid
	TR4	0.846	Valid
Perceived Value	PV1	0.920	Valid
	PV2	0.818	Valid
	PV3	0.871	Valid
	PV4	0.878	Valid
Purchase Intention	PI1	0.920	Valid
	PI2	0.914	Valid
	PI3	0.928	Valid

Cross-border shopping experience	CB1	0.884	Valid
	CB2	0.937	Valid
	CB3	0.929	Valid

The external load values of each measurement item are listed in Table 5.3. The external load is also used to evaluate the reliability of each construct index. This usage example can be seen in the study of Hair et al. (2019), where outer loading values should exceed 0.70 to be considered acceptable. Based on the results, all measurement items in this study have outer loading values ranging from 0.724 to 0.972, which are above the recommended threshold of 0.70. This indicates that all indicators have satisfactory indicator reliability and are strongly associated with their respective constructs. Although a few items (e.g., CC4 = 0.724) are slightly lower than others, they still exceed the minimum acceptable level and are therefore retained. Therefore, all items are retained and considered valid for further analysis.

Table 5.4 AVE Value

Construct	**Average Variance Extracted (AVE)**	**Evaluation**
Content Authenticity	0.685	Valid
Content Credibility	0.697	Valid
Cross-border shopping experience	0.841	Valid
Diagnosticity	0.775	Valid
Entertainment Value	0.746	Valid
Information Quality	0.689	Valid
Perceived Value	0.747	Valid
Purchase Intention	0.847	Valid
Trust	0.757	Valid

In addition to outer loading, convergent validity is also assessed using the Average Variance Extracted (AVE). Hair et al. (2019) pointed out that if a concept can explain more than half of its index variance, its AVE value must be higher than 0.50. The AVE

values for all concepts, shown in Table 5.4, range between 0.685 and 0.847 and all exceed the recommended threshold of 0.50. The adequacy of convergence validity can be seen in each concept. The convergence validity of all concepts in this study is thus established.

5.3.2 Discriminant Validity Test

Discriminant validity is the degree to which a concept can be effectively distinguished from other concepts. In this study, the discriminant validity was tested by the cross-load criterion and the Furnell-Lalk criterion.

Hair et al. (2019) pointed out that in terms of cross-factor load, the load of each index on its own construct should be higher than that on any other construct. In the results shown in Table 5.5, the factor loadings of all indicators on their corresponding constructs are at a high level. It can be seen that the discriminant validity has been supported according to the cross-factor loading standard.

In order to judge the discriminant validity more accurately, the Fornell-Larcker criterion is also introduced. The criterion requires the square root of the average variance extract (AVE) of each construct to be greater than the correlation coefficient between the construct and any other construct. The data presented in Table 5.6 show that all constructs meet this condition and examples further support the establishment of discriminant validity.

Table 5.5 Cross Loading Result

	Content Authenticity	Content Credibility	Cross-border Shopping Experience	Diagnosticity	Entertainment Value	Information Quality	Perceived Value	Purchase Intention	Trust
CA1	**0.809**	0.629	0.166	0.596	0.317	0.620	0.567	0.469	0.601
CA2	**0.818**	0.639	0.259	0.562	0.387	0.667	0.591	0.414	0.575
CA3	**0.876**	0.624	0.272	0.588	0.449	0.594	0.624	0.532	0.553
CA4	**0.806**	0.570	0.327	0.429	0.204	0.483	0.474	0.392	0.565
CB1	0.232	0.241	**0.884**	0.292	0.333	0.267	0.333	0.224	0.255
CB2	0.299	0.296	**0.937**	0.266	0.258	0.248	0.367	0.288	0.282
CB3	0.306	0.345	**0.929**	0.244	0.270	0.206	0.382	0.294	0.298
CC1	0.565	**0.846**	0.254	0.545	0.418	0.592	0.595	0.605	0.612
CC2	0.614	**0.876**	0.281	0.481	0.261	0.511	0.568	0.553	0.668
CC3	0.642	**0.884**	0.265	0.532	0.306	0.559	0.597	0.551	0.653
CC4	0.698	**0.724**	0.296	0.453	0.345	0.544	0.620	0.450	0.480
DI1	0.624	0.569	0.237	**0.854**	0.283	0.642	0.541	0.461	0.554
DI2	0.551	0.549	0.276	**0.902**	0.416	0.626	0.575	0.583	0.551

DI3	0.566	0.472	0.249	**0.885**	0.538	0.598	0.563	0.460	0.489
EV1	0.250	0.249	0.274	0.365	**0.792**	0.383	0.371	0.311	0.221
EV2	0.333	0.313	0.275	0.354	**0.874**	0.390	0.410	0.288	0.246
EV3	0.355	0.368	0.286	0.402	**0.906**	0.433	0.412	0.345	0.298
EV4	0.460	0.412	0.235	0.493	**0.878**	0.485	0.447	0.386	0.373
IQ1	0.566	0.597	0.260	0.576	0.439	**0.826**	0.610	0.468	0.507
IQ2	0.596	0.597	0.175	0.520	0.367	**0.803**	0.549	0.377	0.595
IQ3	0.645	0.527	0.209	0.606	0.447	**0.874**	0.645	0.508	0.628
IQ4	0.565	0.459	0.219	0.645	0.377	**0.817**	0.589	0.423	0.522
PI1	0.536	0.642	0.327	0.518	0.325	0.496	0.662	**0.920**	0.674
PI2	0.461	0.536	0.292	0.484	0.364	0.480	0.624	**0.914**	0.562
PI3	0.506	0.608	0.194	0.573	0.381	0.505	0.629	**0.928**	0.596
PV1	0.618	0.651	0.275	0.606	0.416	0.644	**0.889**	0.639	0.685
PV2	0.532	0.557	0.304	0.496	0.340	0.567	**0.818**	0.499	0.549
PV3	0.588	0.616	0.374	0.540	0.414	0.613	**0.871**	0.626	0.670
PV4	0.613	0.612	0.410	0.550	0.466	0.665	**0.878**	0.623	0.679
TR1	0.575	0.645	0.322	0.520	0.327	0.551	0.622	0.583	**0.867**
TR2	0.657	0.662	0.202	0.475	0.213	0.572	0.601	0.531	**0.894**
TR3	0.642	0.663	0.289	0.529	0.322	0.640	0.702	0.602	**0.872**
TR4	0.539	0.562	0.246	0.574	0.294	0.602	0.684	0.599	**0.846**

Discriminant validity refers to the extent to which a construct is distinct from other constructs. In this study, discriminant validity is first assessed using the cross loading criterion. According to Hair et al. (2019), each indicator should load higher on its associated construct than on other constructs. As shown in Table 5.5, all measurement items exhibit higher loadings on their respective constructs compared to other constructs. This indicates that each construct is empirically distinct and that discriminant validity is established based on the cross loading criterion.

Table 5.6 Fornell-Larcker Criterion Results

	Content Authenticity	Content Credibility	Cross-border shopping experience	Diagnosticity	Entertainment Value	Information Quality	Perceived Value	Purchase Intention	Trust
CA	**0.828**								
CC	0.745	**0.835**							
CB	0.308	0.325	**0.917**						
DI	0.658	0.602	0.289	**0.880**					
EV	0.410	0.392	0.308	0.470	**0.864**				
IQ	0.716	0.656	0.259	0.706	0.492	**0.830**			
PV	0.682	0.706	0.395	0.636	0.476	0.722	**0.864**		

PI	0.546	0.649	0.296	0.570	0.387	0.537	0.694	**0.920**	
TR	0.695	0.729	0.305	0.603	0.333	0.681	0.751	0.666	**0.870**

In addition to cross loading, discriminant validity is further assessed using the Fornell–Larcker criterion. Hair et al. (2019) pointed out that the square root of the average variance extraction value (AVE) of each concept should be greater than the correlation coefficient between the concept and the rest of the concepts. The values shown in the diagonal position in Table 5.6, that is, the square root of AVE, are higher than the correlation coefficients of other concepts in their rows and columns. There are differences among the concepts, so the discriminant validity is guaranteed.

5.3.3 Reliability Test

The internal consistency of the measurement items used to characterize a specific concept is called reliability. The Cronbach's coefficient and the composite reliability coefficient (CR) were used in this study to evaluate the reliability. Hair et al. (2019) pointed out that if the Cronbach's coefficient and composite reliability (CR) value exceed 0.70, they can be regarded as meeting the reliability requirements. The Cronbach's alpha and CR values of all constructs are higher than the recommended thresholds, as shown in Table 5.7. All constructs show satisfactory internal consistency and reliability, which can be seen.

Table 5.7 Composite Reliability and Cronbach's Alpha Value Results

Construct	Composite Reliability	Cronbach's Alpha	Evaluation
Content Authenticity	0.897	0.846	Reliable
Content Credibility	0.902	0.854	Reliable
Cross-border shopping experience	0.940	0.906	Reliable
Diagnosticity	0.912	0.854	Reliable
Entertainment Value	0.921	0.886	Reliable
Information Quality	0.899	0.849	Reliable
Perceived Value	0.922	0.887	Reliable
Purchase Intention	0.943	0.910	Reliable
Trust	0.926	0.893	Reliable

The internal consistency between the measurement points used to represent a specific construct is called reliability. In this study, Cronbach's alpha coefficient and

composite reliability index (CR) were used to evaluate the reliability. Hair et al. 2019) pointed out that if the Cronbach's coefficient and the composite reliability index are to be considered to reach an acceptable level, their values should be higher than 0.70. The Cronbach's coefficients of all constructs are in the range of 0.846 to 0.910, as shown in Table 5.7. The composite reliability value falls in the range of 0.897 to 0.943, both of which exceed the recommended threshold. It can be seen that each construct shows a high degree of internal consistency and reliability. The measurement model is thus considered to be reliable.

5.4 Inferential Statistical Analysis（Structural Model）

Structural model analysis (also known as internal model analysis), which is used to analyze the correlation between latent variables, is applied. The correlation between hidden variables is classified by this kind of analysis method.

5.4.1 Collinearity Assessment

The possible situation of multicollinearity problems in structural model prediction constructs is evaluated in this study. The tool used for this evaluation is the variance inflation factor (VIF). Hair et al. (2019) pointed out that if the VIF value is lower than 5.0, it can be regarded as no significant multicollinearity. The VIF values listed in Table 5.8 are all below the recommended threshold. It can be seen that there is no obvious multicollinearity among the predictive variables, so this structural model is suitable for subsequent analysis.

Table 5.8 Variance Inflation Factor (VIF) Result

Construct	Item	VIF
Content Authenticity	CA1	1.766
	CA2	1.839
	CA3	2.472
	CA4	1.802
Cross-border shopping experience	CB1	2.561
	CB2	3.478
	CB3	3.116
Content Credibility	CC1	2.075
	CC2	2.340

	CC3	2.483
	CC4	1.503
Diagnosticity	DI1	1.887
	DI2	2.434
	DI3	2.234
Entertainment Value	EV1	1.823
	EV2	2.480
	EV3	3.361
	EV4	2.798
Information Quality	IQ1	1.937
	IQ2	1.750
	IQ3	2.336
	IQ4	1.949
Purchase Intention	PI1	2.858
	PI2	3.005
	PI3	3.371
Perceived Value	PV1	2.629
	PV2	2.015
	PV3	2.421
	PV4	2.482
Trust	TR1	2.362
	TR2	2.891
	TR3	2.449
	TR4	2.187

Multicollinearity assessment is implemented to examine the possible multicollinearity among predictors in the structural model. The variance inflation factor (VIF) was used to measure the multicollinearity in this study. Hair et al. (2019) pointed out that when the VIF value is lower than 5.0, multicollinearity does not pose a significant problem. It can be seen from Table 5.8 that all VIF values are distributed in the range of 1.503 to 3.478, which do not exceed the recommended threshold. The problem of non-significant multicollinearity between variables is thus confirmed and the structural model is thus suitable for further in-depth analysis. Although some values are slightly more than 3.0, they are still within the acceptable range.

5.4.2 Coefficient of Determination (R^2)

The coefficient of determination (R^2) is used to evaluate the predictive accuracy of the structural model by measuring the proportion of variance in the endogenous constructs explained by the exogenous constructs. According to Hair et al. (2019), R^2 values of 0.75, 0.50 and 0.25 can be described as substantial, moderate and weak, respectively. As shown in Table 5.9, the R^2 values for the endogenous constructs indicate the level of explanatory power of the model.

Table 5.9 R-Square Value Result

Variable	R-square	R-square adjusted
Perceived Value	0.564	0.557
Purchase Intention	0.530	0.521
Trust	0.617	0.611

The index used to evaluate the prediction accuracy of the structural model is the coefficient of determination (R^2), which is based on the percentage explained by the exogenous variable to the endogenous variable variance. According to Hair et al. (2019), R^2 values of 0.75,0.50 and 0.2 can be considered as high, medium and low levels, respectively, from 0. The R^2 value corresponding to the trust degree is 0.617, as shown in Table 5.9 and the prediction accuracy is moderate. The R^2 value of perceived value (0.564) and purchase intention (0.530) also shows that the explanatory power is at a medium level.

5.4.3 Effect Size (f^2)

The effect size (f^2) used to evaluate the effect of each exogenous variable on the endogenous variable is obtained by observing the change of R value when a specific variable is added or removed in the model. According to Hair et al. (2019), if the f value is 0.35, 0.15 and 0.02, the corresponding effect is significant, moderate and weak.

The effect strength in the whole structural model varies from weak to medium, which can be reflected by the f^2 value shown in table 5.10. The interaction term of ' cross-border shopping experience × trust ' is also included in the analysis process and its contribution to the model can be seen. The relationship between most variables is weak effect or moderate effect and the influence of moderating effect is relatively weak.

Table 5.10 f-square Value Result

	Content Authenticity	Content Credibility	Cross-border shopping experience	Diagnosticity	Entertainment Value	Information Quality	Perceived Value	Purchase Intention	Trust
CA									0.037
CC									0.172
CB									
DI							0.054		
EV							0.026		
IQ							0.273		0.090
PV								0.165	
PI									
TR								0.098	
CB x TR								0.000	

The effect size (f^2) is used to measure the impact of each exogenous variable on the endogenous variable, which is calculated by observing the change of R value when a variable is introduced or removed in the model. According to the standard proposed by Hair et al. (2019), if the f values are 0.35,0.15 and 0.02, the corresponding influence degree can be regarded as significant, medium and weak respectively. The results shown in Table 5.10 indicate that the intensity of each effect is between weak and moderate in the overall structural model. The effect of some interactions is small and some other variables show a medium level of effect. In terms of purchase intention, the interaction between cross-border shopping experience and trust has little effect. It can be seen that there are different degrees of influence among the internal variables of the model.

5.4.4 Predictive Relevance (Q^2)

The predictive ability (Q^2) is used to measure the prediction accuracy of the structural model by means of ' blindfolding ' or PLSpredict, to judge the prediction performance of the model in terms of endogenous variable observations. Hair et al. (2019) pointed out that when the Q value is positive, the model is considered to have predictive power. The Q^2 values listed in Table 5.11 are all positive, which shows that the prediction ability of the model is satisfactory. The Q^2 values corresponding to all

endogenous variables are higher than zero and the predictive ability of the model can be regarded as sufficient.

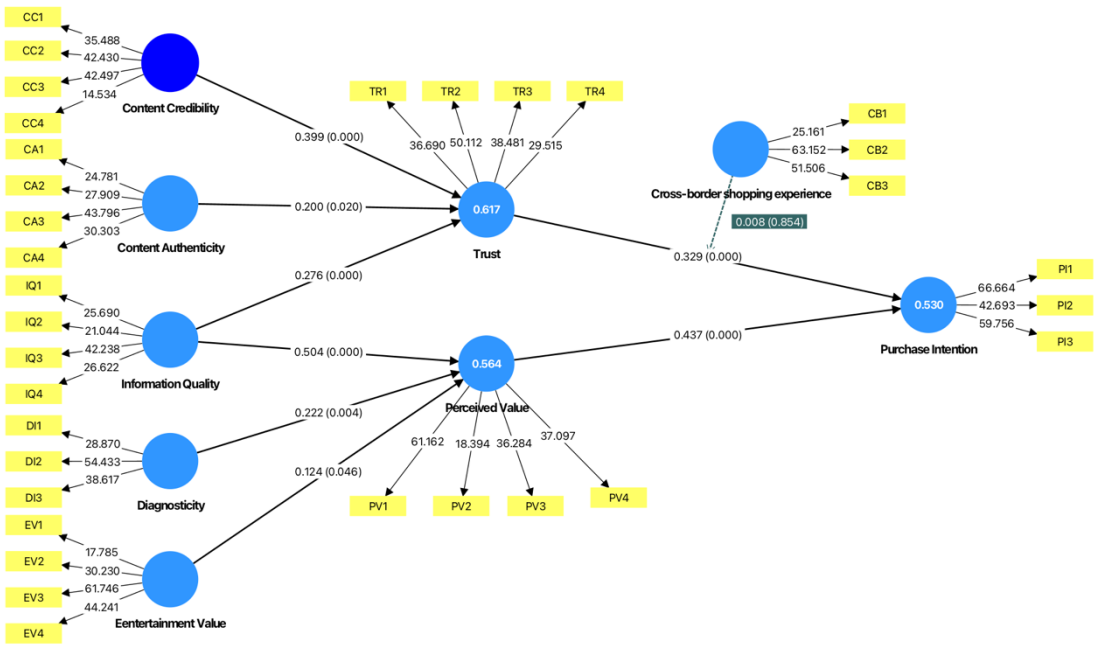
Table 5.11 Q-Square Value Result

	Q^2 predict
Perceived Value	0.544
Purchase Intention	0.394
Trust	0.595

As shown in Table 5.11, indicators with Q^2 values greater than zero include ' trust ' (0.595), ' perceived value ' (0.544) and ' purchase intention ' (0.394). The prediction ability of the model is good, as can be seen. The example shows that the prediction performance is satisfactory.

5.5 Hypothesis Testing

The exploration of the correlation between variables is carried out through hypothesis testing. In this study, the significance evaluation is based on the weight coefficient, t value and p value obtained by the Bootstrapping method and the proposed correlation hypothesis is verified. It can be seen that the establishment of the relationship between variables in the structural model depends on the comprehensive



judgment of the above statistical indicators. The example shows that the weight coefficient and the corresponding significance level jointly determine whether the hypothesis is supported.

Figure 4.1 Structural Model Analysis

The results of the structural model are shown in Figure 4.1 and the path coefficients and their significance levels obtained by the bootstrapping method are presented. The relationship between variables is revealed by these results, and the R value of endogenous variables is also given. The strength and direction of the relationship are indicated by the path coefficient and the significance of each hypothesis is determined by the p-value. It can be seen that the larger the path coefficient, the more obvious the correlation of the corresponding variables; examples show that the p-values of several paths are lower than the conventional threshold, suggesting that their statistical significance is established.

5.5.1 Path Coefficients Test

In order to investigate the strength and direction of the relationship between the constructs in the structural model, orientation analysis was carried out. The significance of each relationship was evaluated by the orientation coefficient (β), t value and p value, which were obtained by the Bootstrapping method. Hair et al. (2019) pointed out that at the 5 % significance level, if the p-value is less than 0.05 and the t-value is greater than 1.96, the relationship is statistically significant. Table 5.12 shows that the strength of the relationship between constructs is reflected by the direction coefficient and the significance of each hypothesis relationship is determined by the t value and the p value.

Table 5.12 Hypothesis Testing: Path Coefficient Analysis

Hypothesis		Path Coefficient	STERR	T statistics	P values	Result
H1	Content Credibility → Trust	0.399	0.078	5.131	0.000	Supported
H2	Content Authenticity → Trust	0.200	0.086	2.321	0.020	Supported
H3	Information Quality → Trust	0.276	0.076	3.624	0.000	Supported

H4	Information Quality → Perceived Value	0.504	0.069	7.304	0.000	Supported
H5	Diagnosticity → Perceived Value	0.222	0.077	2.884	0.004	Supported
H6	Entertainment Value → Perceived Value	0.124	0.062	2.000	0.046	Not Supported
H7	Trust → Purchase Intention	0.329	0.087	3.779	0.000	Supported
H8	Perceived Value → Purchase Intention	0.437	0.091	4.809	0.000	Supported
H9	Cross-border shopping experience x Trust → Purchase Intention	0.008	0.043	0.183	0.854	Not Supported

The results indicate that most of the hypothesized relationships are statistically significant. Content credibility ($\beta = 0.399$, $t = 5.131$, $p < 0.05$), content authenticity ($\beta = 0.200$, $t = 2.321$, $p < 0.05$) and information quality ($\beta = 0.276$, $t = 3.624$, $p < 0.05$) have significant positive effects on trust. Information quality ($\beta = 0.504$, $t = 7.304$, $p < 0.05$) and diagnosticity ($\beta = 0.222$, $t = 2.884$, $p < 0.05$) also significantly influence perceived value. Entertainment value is found to have a significant effect on perceived value ($\beta = 0.124$, $t = 2.000$, $p < 0.05$); however, the direction of the relationship is positive, which is inconsistent with the hypothesized negative relationship. Therefore, H6 is not supported. Furthermore, trust ($\beta = 0.329$, $t = 3.779$, $p < 0.05$) and perceived value ($\beta = 0.437$, $t = 4.809$, $p < 0.05$) significantly influence purchase intention. However, the moderating effect of cross-border shopping experience on the relationship between trust and purchase intention is not significant ($\beta = 0.008$, $t = 0.183$, $p > 0.05$), and the example shows that H9 is not confirmed. In summary, H1, H2, H3, H4, H5, H7 and H8 obtained data support, while H6 and H9 did not pass the test.

5.6 Summary of Data Analysis

This chapter presents the results of data analysis using partial least squares structural equation model (PLS-SEM). After the evaluation of the sample size, it shows that each construct has sufficient reliability and validity.

The factor loading coefficients all exceeded the recommended threshold of 0.70 and the average variance extraction (AVE) was also higher than 0.50, indicating the sufficiency of the convergent validity. The discriminant validity was established by cross-loading and the Fornell-Larcker criterion.

In terms of internal consistency, all constructs performed well and the Cronbach's coefficient and composite reliability value were higher than 0.70. The multicollinearity problem in the structural model is not found, because all VIF values are lower than the recommended threshold.

The R^2 value corresponding to trust, perceived value and purchase intention reflects a moderate degree of prediction accuracy. The effect size (f^2) reflects the strength of the relationship between variables in the small to medium range, while the predictive validity (Q^2) value confirms that the model has good predictive ability.

The hypothesis test results show that most of the proposed hypotheses are supported and there is a significant correlation between the constructs. However, H6 and H9 hypotheses are not supported. Although there is a significant correlation between pleasure and perceived value, its direction is not consistent with the negative effect expected by the original hypothesis.

The moderating effect of cross-border shopping experience on the relationship between trust and purchase intention is not significant.

In summary, the model is reliable at the statistical level and provides an important reference for understanding the driving factors of consumers buying Chinese cross-border products on the TikTok platform.

Table 5.13 Data Analysis Results

Research Hypothesis	**Research Result**
H1: Content credibility positively influences consumer trust toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.	Supported
H2: Content authenticity positively influences consumer trust toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.	Supported

H3: Information quality positively influences consumer trust toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.	Supported
H4: Information quality positively influences perceived value toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.	Supported
H5: Information diagnosticity positively influences perceived value toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.	Supported
H6: Entertainment value negatively influences perceived value toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.	Not Supported
H7: Consumer trust positively influences purchase intention toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.	Supported
H8: Perceived value positively influences purchase intention toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.	Supported
H9: Cross-border shopping experience moderates the relationship between consumer trust and purchase intention toward Chinese cross-border products on TikTok.	Not Supported

Chapter 6 Discussion and Conclusion

6.1 Research Findings

This section combines research hypotheses and existing literature to discuss the empirical results. The impact of cross-border marketing content on TikTok platform on the trust, value perception and purchase intention of Chinese cross-border products among Malaysian consumers will be discussed based on the results of PLS-SEM analysis. The formation of trust is driven by the characteristics of marketing content; the perception of value is shaped by the presentation of content; the strength of purchase intention also changes with the level of content interaction. It can be seen that there is a clear correlation between marketing content elements and consumer psychological reactions. The example shows that high frequency exposure and localization expression significantly improve the user's judgment of product credibility.

1. Content Credibility Positively Influences Consumer Trust

According to hypothesis 1, the results reveal that content credibility has a significant positive effect on consumer trust ($\beta = 0.399$, $t = 5.131$, $p = 0.000$). If Malaysian consumers regard the marketing materials of Chinese goods on the TikTok platform as trustworthy, reliable and effective, their trust in the products and sellers will also increase, which can be seen.

This result is consistent with the existing literature. Lou and Yuan (2019) pointed out that information credibility constitutes the basic premise for consumers to trust brand content in social media. Saima and Khan (2020) also found that trust in celebrity online celebrities can strengthen consumer response and lead to better purchase-related outcomes. In the context of social e-commerce, trust is still the key mechanism for the connection between online information cues and actual purchase behavior.

In the context of this study, trust is particularly important in the process of cross-border purchase of Chinese goods, because buyers cannot inspect goods on the spot before trading. Buyers then rely on the credibility of TikTok videos, product descriptions, display content and manufacturer information to build trust. Examples can be seen in the data results.

2. Content Authenticity Positively Influences Consumer Trust

Regarding the second hypothesis, the results show that content authenticity has a significant positive effect on customer trust (β = 0.200, t = 2.321, p = 0.020). The content perceived as true, natural and sincere helps to enhance customer trust, which can be seen. The emphasis on the importance of authenticity in online celebrity marketing and social media scenarios in previous studies has been supported by this finding. The conclusion of the establishment of related trust between the content value of web celebrity and its credibility was put forward by Lou and Yuan (2019). Alice Audrezet et al. (2020) pointed out that in the context of business pressure, ' authenticity ' is critical for social media celebrities to maintain fan trust. Kim and Kim (2021) also emphasize that authenticity as a relationship bond plays an important role in the construction of social media fans ' trust. In the context of TikTok marketing, when the product video is less pretentious and more realistic, Malaysian users show a more positive response, as can be seen from the examples. Consequently, personal demonstrations, real-life scenes of product use and expressions that avoid excessive commercialisation could help to strengthen consumer trust in Chinese cross-border sellers.

3. Information Quality Positively Influences Consumer Trust

For hypothesis 3, the results indicated that the quality of information had a significant positive effect on consumer trust (β = 0.276; t = 3.624; p = 0.000). If the information presented in TikTok video is clear, accurate and practical, consumers ' trust in the promoted products will be enhanced. Consistent with the conclusion of Filieri (2015), information quality is regarded as a key factor for users to evaluate online reviews and product-related content.

Lu et al. (2016) also found that social commerce signals can affect users ' trust in sellers, which is of great significance to subsequent purchase decisions. It can be seen that the current research on social commerce trust generally points out that information cues constitute the basic conditions for trust establishment. The results of this study further show that the content on the TikTok platform should cover sufficient product details in addition to being attractive. When users receive easy-to-understand and practical information, their uncertainty in purchasing decisions will be reduced and trust relationships will be easier to form.

4. Information Quality Positively Influences Perceived Value

For hypothesis 4, the results of the analysis showed that information quality has a significant positive effect on perceived value (β = 0.504; t = 7.304; p = 0.000). In this

study, the explanatory variable that is most closely related to perceived value is this. Information quality has a key impact on consumers ' evaluation of Chinese products promoted on TikTok for overseas markets (such as judging whether they are practical, cost-effective or extremely cost-effective). The results are consistent with previous studies. Some studies have pointed out that if the information is of high quality, it can effectively improve the user 's evaluation of the product and the perception of its value. Filieri (2015) has emphasized that online information, if of high quality, plays an important role in the process of consumers ' evaluation of products. Guo and Li (2022) found that the functions of social e-commerce can enhance perceived value, which in turn promotes purchase behavior. When TikTok video content contains detailed descriptions, clearly presents product advantages and is supplemented by practical demonstrations, Malaysian consumers are more inclined to think that cross-border goods from China are more valuable, as can be seen from examples. In other words, the perception of value depends to a large extent on the practicality of the information provided, not just on the visual level of display.

5. Diagnosticity Positively Influences Perceived Value

Regarding Hypothesis 5, the results revealed that diagnostic value had a significant positive effect on perceived value ($\beta = 0.222$, $t = 2.884$, $p = 0.004$). When the content presented by the TikTok platform assists users in judging product characteristics, identifying the benefits it provides and measuring whether it meets individual needs, the perceived value can be improved. The research of Jiang and Benbasat (2007) also pointed out that it is of great significance to have a display mechanism that strengthens consumers ' product evaluation ability. This conclusion is consistent with the findings of this study.

Similarly, Filieri (2015) has confirmed that relevant information with evaluation utility can optimize product evaluation in a network environment and examples support this research point of view. If the content plays an evaluation auxiliary function on TikTok, rather than being limited to promotional purposes, it will be given higher value. The demonstration form, use situation, comparative presentation and practical interpretation all help Malaysian users regard Chinese cross-border goods as more valuable objects.

6. Entertainment Value Negatively Influences Perceived Value

Suppose that H6 is not supported. Although the relationship between entertainment value and perceived value is statistically significant ($\beta = 0.124$, $t = 2.000$,

p = 0.046), a positive correlation, rather than a negative correlation, was observed. It can be seen that the negative correlation expected by the original hypothesis has not been confirmed by the empirical results, so the hypothesis is rejected.

This finding has certain significance. The initial setting of the research is: if the entertainment value is too high, it will disperse the user's attention to the product-related information, resulting in a decrease in perceived value. However, the reality is the opposite: the more interesting the TikTok content, the higher the value perceived by users.

Examples can be seen in the short video related to the literature. Meng et al. (2024) have pointed out that the key features of TikTok short video ads will have an impact on consumer purchase behavior. Luo et al. (2025) also emphasized that the entertainment value of short video content has a significant effect on trust and purchase intention.

The above studies together show that the form of entertaining content is not only for recreational purposes, but also plays a role in persuasion and user participation. One possible explanation is that the TikTok platform is essentially entertainment-oriented. The interaction mode of users on this platform is obviously different from that of traditional e-commerce websites. Highly entertaining content can enhance attention, prolong viewing time, enhance emotional engagement and improve the overall acceptance of product details. Product videos are highly entertaining and therefore are seen by users as more attractive and interesting content, rather than insufficient information. Another possible explanation is that for young TikTok users in Malaysia, entertainment and value are not necessarily mutually exclusive. Rather, an engaging presentation can make a product appear more appealing, contemporary, and memorable.

Therefore, this finding does not undermine the conclusions of this study. Rather, it presents an interesting perspective: namely, that the role of entertainment in cross-border marketing on TikTok may differ from the researchers' initial assumptions and should be interpreted based on the logic of short-form video consumption.

7. Consumer Trust Positively Influences Purchase Intention

Regarding Hypothesis 7, the results of this study confirm that consumer trust has a significant positive effect on purchase intention ($\beta = 0.329$, $t = 3.779$, $p = 0.000$). When the degree of trust in Chinese products and foreign sellers increases, the purchase intention of Malaysian consumers is also more likely to increase. This finding is generally consistent with the existing research. Lu et al. (2016) pointed out that in the context of social media-driven e-commerce, seller trust plays a key role. Hajli et al.

(2017) also showed that trust constitutes the basic mechanism affecting purchase intention in the context of social media e-commerce ; subsequent meta-analysis further supports this view, showing that trust is one of the most stable influencing factors in online purchasing decisions.

For this study, this conclusion is particularly important - cross-border shopping introduces additional uncertainties in logistics distribution, product authenticity and after-sales protection. In such situations, trust has become a key intermediary element that promotes the transformation of positive cognition to actual purchase intention.

8. Perceived Value Positively Influences Purchase Intention

For hypothesis 8, the results showed that perceived value has a significant positive influence on purchase intention ($\beta = 0.437$; $t = 4.809$; $p = 0.000$). This means that when consumers perceive Chinese cross-border products as offering 'good value for money', 'having practical value' or 'being worth the price', they tend to be more willing to purchase them on TikTok.

This finding is consistent with previous studies. Gan and Wang (2017) revealed that perceived value in social commerce has a significant positive effect on purchase intention. Guo and Li (2022) also noted that perceived value in the context of social commerce fosters repurchase intention, whilst Wu et al. (2023) further demonstrated that perceived value plays an important role in the live-streaming commerce purchasing process.

The results of this study suggest that Malaysian consumers do not rely solely on reliability. They also assess whether Chinese cross-border products promoted on TikTok are worthwhile in terms of practicality and value for money. This perception makes value a key psychological mechanism for transforming content exposure into purchase intention.

9. Cross-border shopping experience moderates the relationship between consumer trust and purchase intention

Hypothesis H9 was not confirmed. The moderating role of cross-border shopping experience in the relationship between trust and purchase intention is not significant ($\beta = 0.008$, $t = 0.183$, $p = 0.854$).

This indicates that, in the group under study, prior experience of cross-border shopping did not significantly strengthen or weaken the influence of trust on purchase intention.

Some results obtained in this study are not statistically significant and should not be simply classified as limitations. The impact of security and e-commerce experience on consumer trust and purchase decisions has been supported by considerable literature. Gefen (2000) pointed out that knowledge plays a key role in the construction of e-commerce trust; Stouthuysen et al. (2018) specifically explored online shopping experience as a mediating variable in the relationship between trust and purchase intention. Recent studies in the field of cross-border e-commerce have also generally shown that trust is still the core element driving purchase intention in cross-border situations.

As far as the TikTok platform is concerned, the direct clue conveyed by the content may be more influential than the user's past cross-border shopping experience, which is a possible explanation for the above findings. When users watch product videos, the formation of their purchase intention mainly depends on whether the content can immediately arouse trust and convey perceived value, rather than whether they have previous cross-border consumption experience.

Sample homogeneity constitutes another potential reason. Most of the respondents are young and active TikTok users, so the difference of digital literacy is limited, and the mediating effect is difficult to appear. Cross-border shopping experience may indirectly moderate the strength of the link between trust and purchase intention and is more likely to act in the early stages of evaluation - such as reducing uncertainty or facilitating information processing.

Even if the hypothesis H9 is not supported by empirical evidence, the results are still instructive. It can be seen that regardless of the user's cross-border shopping experience, trust is of general importance to their purchasing decisions.

6.2 Research Recommendations

6.2.1 Recommendations for Sellers

Based on the results of this study, several operational suggestions are put forward for merchants selling Chinese goods to overseas consumers through the TikTok platform. The measures listed are intended to assist merchants to strengthen consumer trust, enhance the perceived value of goods and promote purchase intention.

1. Credibility and authenticity should be placed in the priority position
   Video content needs to show a true and credible state, which is guaranteed by the seller. The content has credibility and authenticity and is found to be the

main reason for users ' trust in brand initiation. Avoid making promises that sound too idealistic and instead state facts that are reliable. The demonstration of how the product works in the actual use situation can enhance the customer 's trust in the store.

2. The quality of information that must be clear and practical is confirmed by the data as a key element to enhance perceived value. The video should be embedded with clear and accurate details, covering product functions, usage methods and value embodiments. The provision of high-quality information helps buyers deepen their understanding of products and the concerns associated with cross-border shopping can be alleviated.
3. Decision support dependent on the introduction of diagnostic content
   The so-called ' diagnostic ' element refers to the specific details that can assist customers in evaluating products and its introduction is of positive significance. This kind of content includes the presentation of the actual operation effect of the product, the comparison with other competitive products, or the display of the use scene in the real home environment. Since online shoppers can 't touch or try products in person, such videos are indispensable for highlighting product quality and enhancing the perceived value of the products sold.
4. The balance between entertainment and information needs to be found
   The initial view is that the entertainment component is too much or weakens the product value, but the research results reveal that the two are positively correlated. In other words, if used properly, entertainment content can indeed help business development. Video production should take into account both attractiveness and information content. The goal is to be both compelling and rich in substance, rather than relying solely on funny bridge segments to win clicks.
5. Trust building and perceived value promotion should be synchronized to promote trust and perceived value, which are the two core factors driving purchase behavior, so they need to be achieved in parallel. Sincere video expression combined with practical product information can effectively achieve this dual goal. Simply attracting attention is not enough to facilitate transactions. Before the final decision, the customer must feel at ease and be sure that the purchase is worth paying.

6.2.2 Recommendations for Policymakers

The study also puts forward some suggestions, which are of reference value to policy makers, especially in the field of international online trade and social media advertising.

1. More stringent regulations on consumer protection in cross-border e-commerce should be introduced by policymakers to regulate cross-border transactions. The rationality of the return policy, the quality of the goods and the clarity of the delivery information are all covered. As a key factor affecting purchasing decisions, trust plays an important role. The improvement of users ' sense of peace of mind and the enhancement of online shopping security can be seen in the consequences of the implementation of more effective consumer protection regulations.
2. The promotion of transparency in social media marketing. Regulators need to work on clearer rules to regulate the way of product display on platforms such as TikTok. This is one of the examples where the seller of a product promoted for a fee must clearly state this fact. Another example is to prevent the seller from publishing false information only to promote sales. The establishment of higher trust in the digital environment depends on an open and honest way of communication.
3. Education programs to improve consumers ' digital literacy can be launched by policymakers to help the public deepen their understanding of online advertising. Critical viewing of product videos, comparison of details and identification of sellers with high reliability are all abilities that consumers should master. In the context of cross-border shopping, such skills are particularly important and it is often difficult to judge whether the product is worth the money. By teaching the above skills, regulators can help consumers make more informed choices and improve their satisfaction with the purchase experience.

6.2.3 Recommendations for Researchers

Based on the limitations of this study and the results obtained, follow-up researchers can further explore from multiple dimensions.

1. Re-exploration of the role of entertainment value. Entertainment has a positive impact on perceived value, which is different from the initial assumption. Different forms of entertainment content - such as films with humorous elements, creative expressions, or strong emotions - can be used to analyze the

phenomenon in depth. It can be seen from this example that how entertainment reshapes consumers ' perception of product value will be clearer.

2. Examination of other moderating variables. The cross-border shopping experience did not show a significant moderating effect in this study, so the follow-up work should turn to other potential variables. Factors such as personal risk aversion, level of interest in specific categories and even personality traits may be more effective in explaining why beliefs become a core element driving purchase intentions in certain contexts. It can be seen that these variables are worthy of system verification.
3. The expansion of sample diversity. The current sample is concentrated on young TikTok users and the conclusion may not be applicable to other populations. Future research needs to include participants with a larger age span, different nationalities, or diverse cultural backgrounds. Through such sample expansion, we can judge whether the relationship between beliefs and perceived value is cross-group universal.
4. Extension of the intermediary mechanism. There may be other intermediary psychological processes between video viewing and actual purchase. For example, the overall emotional state during viewing, the depth of interaction between users and content and the degree of perceived risk should be taken into account. Examples show that integrating the above factors can help to reveal the real path of TikTok marketing affecting consumer behavior more completely.

6.3 Research Limitations

Although this study provides some valuable insights into understanding the impact of TikTok on users, some limitations need to be taken into account. The most critical is the cross-sectional study design, so that all data are obtained at a single time point. Although the elements in the study are closely related, it is still difficult to determine whether a certain element is the cause of another element.

It should also be noted that the data is derived from non-random samples and the respondents are selected according to their own use experience or other people 's introduction. Although this approach facilitates the rapid targeting of TikTok users, it is doubtful whether the results can be extended to the entire Malaysian population. This

problem is particularly prominent, because most of the respondents in Gaines are aged between 18 and 24 years old.

Admittedly, this age group constitutes the largest group on TikTok, but its beliefs and values in terms of cognitive attitudes, or with older users are different.

In addition, the survey was conducted in the form of a self-administered questionnaire and the results were dependent on the respondents ' self-stated views or feelings. This approach may lead to bias in specific situations, because some interviewees may respond according to the image they want to present, rather than reflecting real behavior. Furthermore, this study only includes one ' moderating variable ' : personal cross-border shopping experience.

This variable does not seem to have a significant effect on the results, so there may be other more appropriate factors to explain how beliefs are translated into actual purchase intentions.

Finally, it should be noted that this study focuses on Malaysian users who search for Chinese cross-border goods on TikTok. There are subtle differences between countries and various types of applications, so it is necessary to be cautious when applying the same mechanism to other situations or product types. Based on the above points, it is expected to obtain a more comprehensive understanding in the process of improving the research methods of online purchase behavior in the future.

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Appendix

Survey on TikTok Cross-Border Marketing and Purchase Intention

Hello! I'm Dang Wen Lin, a student majoring in International Business at Zhejiang Gongshang University. Please recall a recent TikTok video promoting a Chinese brand or Chinese product that you have watched. Based on your actual thoughts and feelings while watching that video, please answer the following questions. There are no right or wrong answers. All responses are for academic research purposes only, so please answer according to your real experience.

Section 1 Screening Question

1. Do you use TikTok?
   - ○ Yes
   - ○ No
2. Have you watched TikTok videos promoting Chinese products?
   - ○ Yes
   - ○ No

Section 2 Demographic Information

1. Gender
   - ○ Male
   - ○ Female
2. Age
   - ○ 18-24
   - ○ 25-34
   - ○ 35-44
   - ○ 44 and above
3. Education Level
   - ○ Diploma
   - ○ Bachelor's Degree
   - ○ Master's Degree
   - ○ Others
4. Frequency of TikTok Use
   - ○ Daily

○ Several times a week

○ Occasionally

5. Have you purchased Chinese products via TikTok before?

○ Yes

○ No

Section 3 Likert scale questions

Please think about TikTok videos promoting Chinese products that you have. watched. Indicate your level of agreement with the following statements.

Scale：

1 = Strongly disagree

2 = Disagree

3 = Neutral

4 = Agree

5 = Strongly agree

Content Credibility

No.	Statement	1	2	3	4	5
1.	The TikTok content about Chinese products is credible.					
2.	I believe the information presented in these TikTok videos.					
3.	The product-related content on TikTok seems trustworthy.					
4.	The TikTok creator appears knowledgeable about the product.					

Content Authenticity

No.	Statement	1	2	3	4	5
1.	The TikTok content feels genuine.					
2.	The creator honestly shares their experience with the product.					
3.	The product demonstration appears realistic.					
4.	The content does not seem overly staged.					

Information Quality

No.	Statement	1	2	3	4	5

1.	The TikTok content provides clear product information.					
2.	The information in the video is accurate.					
3.	The content provides sufficient details about the product.					
4.	The information is useful for evaluating the product.					

Diagnosticity

No.	Statement	1	2	3	4	5
1.	The TikTok video helps me judge the product quality.					
2.	The content helps me make a purchase decision.					
3.	The product presentation makes evaluation easier.					

Entertainment Value

No.	Statement	1	2	3	4	5
1.	The TikTok content is entertaining.					
2.	Watching the video is enjoyable.					
3.	The video is fun to watch.					
4.	The content captures my attention.					

Trust

No.	Statement	1	2	3	4	5
1.	I trust the seller of the Chinese product.					
2.	I believe the seller is honest.					
3.	I feel confident about buying this product.					
4.	I think the seller keeps promises.					

Perceived Value

No.	Statement	1	2	3	4	5
1.	The product offers good value for money.					
2.	The product is worth its price.					
3.	The product is beneficial to me.					
4.	Overall, the product is valuable.					

Purchase Intention

No.	Statement	1	2	3	4	5
1.	I intend to purchase Chinese products through TikTok.					
2.	I am likely to buy such products in the future.					
3.	I would consider purchasing after watching TikTok videos.					

Cross-border Shopping Experience

No.	Statement	1	2	3	4	5
1.	I have prior experience purchasing cross-border products.					
2.	I am familiar with cross-border online shopping.					
3.	I often buy products from overseas sellers.					

Section 4 Open-ended question (optional)

1. Do you have any comments or suggestions regarding TikTok videos promoting. Chinese products?